

look for known vulnerabilities in you external dependencies?

Release

- Using GitLab CI/CD to deploy their product (either the customer tells us this or we can see a high number of deployments and/or environments in the Usage Ping data).
- From a feature standpoint, if they are using 2 of the following features...
 - Pages
 - Review Apps
 - Feature Flags
 - Release Orchestration

Usage Discovery Questions:

1. Are you using GitLab to deploy your applications?
1. Do you use GitLab Pages to create, manage and deploy static sites?
1. Are you making use of review apps to get a full production like environment in every merge request?
1. How do you currently manage your releases? (i.e. versioning, release notes, etc.)

Configure

- Using AutoDevOps, Kubernetes or Infrastructure As Code with 25% of teams or projects.

Usage Discovery Questions:

1. Are you using AutoDevOps to provide your users a pre-defined CI/CD configuration?
1. Are you using Kubernetes for any of the following scenarios?
 1. Deploying software from GitLab CI/CD pipelines to Kubernetes
 1. Using Kubernetes to manage runners attached to your GitLab instance
 1. Running the GitLab application and services on a Kubernetes cluster

Monitor

- Using Prometheus & Grafana to monitor their GitLab server.
- Or using Prometheus to monitor 25% of their project deployments.

Usage Discovery Questions:

1. How are you monitoring the stability and performance of your GitLab instance?
1. What do you use to monitor your deployed applications?

Software Supply Chain Security

- Vulnerability List
- Dependency List
- Security Policies
- Making use of Audit Events at the instance level as part of managing GitLab.
- Using Compliance Management within GitLab.

Usage Discovery Questions:

1. How do you manage HTTP traffic to your deployed application?
1. What do you use to block malicious traffic before it reaches your application?
1. How are you managing your Container Image for known vulnerabilities?
1. How are protecting your Kubernetes deployment for security threats at host / network level?

SECTION: customer-success/csm/support.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

Context/Request: For an ORG I manage, I would like to request that the AM id gets changed which is used to link to the correct collaboration project from ZD org view.

Org: <https://gitlab.zendesk.com/agent/organizations/11111111/tickets>

The AM ID should therefore be: 17735787 and finally point to
<https://gitlab.com/<collaborationprojecturl>>

Ref. of handbook: <https://handbook.gitlab.com/handbook/support/workflows/lookingupcustomertechnicaldetails/architecture-diagram-and-customer-success-project>

Once done and the AM id was updated, the link itself will be visible within ZD in an existing ticket, when you click on "Apps" at the top right within the single ticket view.

Support Ticket Notifications

When a CSM is assigned to an account in Salesforce, any time that a user from that account submits a support ticket, the CSM will receive an email to let them know, which includes a link to the Zendesk ticket and a Salesforce case. The email will also include the account name, contact name and email, and the date the ticket was opened. CSMs should receive the email within 1-2 hours of the ticket being opened.

In the email notifying CSMs of new tickets, the included Zendesk ticket link currently leads directly to the ticket. In the past, it has been a .json file which is difficult to read and sometimes doesn't load. If you encounter this, there are a few ways to work around this:

1. Open the Salesforce case link instead. You will be unable to take any action on the ticket, but you will be able to read it.
1. Open the Zendesk ticket link, then edit the URL so it takes you to the ticket itself rather than the .json. For example, <https://gitlab.zendesk.com/api/v2/tickets/123456.json> is the format of the ticket link in the email, but by deleting /api/v2 and .json and then going to that new link, <https://gitlab.zendesk.com/tickets/123456>, you will be taken directly to the ticket.
1. Go to Zendesk and search for the ticket (by copying the ticket number or searching for the

customer).

1. Get the Redirector Chrome extension or the Redirector Firefox add-on and import the below configuration:

```
json
{
  "createdBy": "Redirector v3.5.2",
  "createdAt": "2020-03-11T16:25:30.936Z",
  "redirects": [
    {
      "description": "Redirect zendesk tickets",
      "exampleUrl": "https://gitlab.zendesk.com/api/v2/tickets/12345.json",
      "exampleResult": "https://gitlab.zendesk.com/tickets/12345",
      "error": null,
      "includePattern": "https://gitlab.zendesk.com/api/v2/tickets/([0-9]+).json",
      "excludePattern": "",
      "patternDesc": "",
      "redirectUrl": "https://gitlab.zendesk.com/tickets/$1",
      "patternType": "R",
      "processMatches": "noProcessing",
      "disabled": false,
      "appliesTo": [
        "mainframe"
      ]
    }
  ]
}
```

Provide Customer Feedback on Support Tickets

Sometimes CSMS receive feedback on a support ticket from a customer via email. This feedback can be positive or negative. You can feed back that information to the support management team by following the instructions under points 3 and 4 in the Sources of feedback section of the Support Satisfaction (SSAT) workflow documentation. The SSAT Reviewing Manager will pick up and action the feedback.

As described at that link, support already collects feedback via an automatic email survey and a mid-ticket feedback link. It can be helpful to remind customers about these options from time to time. You'll still see the feedback when reviewing a customer's support tickets prior to cadence calls.

Support Contact Management Projects

CSM guidance on contact management projects.

Who has access to a Contact Management Projects?

- Due to their sensitive nature for our customers, only Customer Support Operations and the customers' chosen users have access to a contact management project.

How do I know if my customer has a contacts management project?

- The best source is to check the organization within Zendesk. It will have a field on the left sidebar toward the bottom called Contact Management Project ID that points to the project being used. If that field has a value, the customer has a contact management project.

How do I know which customer users can access the contacts management project?

- The people who can access the contact management project are stored in the CMP Developers field on the organization page (right below Contact Management Project ID)

How do I know which users can open support tickets?

- Within the customer's organization in Zendesk, there is a Users tab that syncs with the contacts management project and will show who has support entitlement.

Helpful links

- Official GitLab Support Documentation
- Support Handbook (SLA + Tiers)
- GitLab.com Status and Notifications
- Customer Onboarding
- Escalation Process

SECTION: customer-success/csm/workshops.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

Overview

The CSM team's primary focus is to align with a customer's desired business outcomes, enable the customer in their current use cases, and expand their platform adoption.

Customers who adopt additional DevOps use cases with GitLab see an increased return on investment (ROI). They receive this ROI by increasing operational efficiencies, delivering better products faster, and reducing security and compliance risks.

One of the tools CSMs have to speed customer onboarding, increase user adoption, and drive stage adoption is to offer their customers Workshops or Lunch-and-Learns (generically referred to as enablement sessions).

CSM-led Enablement and Expansion

Use-case Enablement: Enabling the use cases into which a customer expresses readiness to adopt as a part of their desired business outcome. CSMs enable customers by creating quick time to value, overcoming technical roadblocks, and ensuring stickiness. The CSM provides the customer

with guidance on adopting use cases to maximize value attribution and to align adoption to the customer's desired positive business outcomes. CSM-led enablement can occur via workshops as listed below and is a part of the CSM-led customer success plan.

Use-case Expansion: Driving expansion into new use cases as a part of an account planning motion, in line with the SAE or AE, to ensure the customer receives increasing ROI and creates happy customers that grow. This motion starts with a discovery process to open the door to a more in-depth discovery, with demos and workshops focused on value-positioning that lead to the customer saying 'yes' and agreeing to adopt that use case. The CSM can track this expansion within an existing success plan objective or create a different objective to track this expansion initiative.

Where do I track the use-case enablement and expansion?

The steps to expand or enable on a use case are a part of the success plan, and are a part of a larger motion to drive towards a customer's desired business outcome (leading to product adoption milestones being realized)

Frequency of Enablement Sessions

As often as needed. For PR1 Customers, we look to see an enablement session at a minimum every 6 months. For PR2, every 12 months.

The CSM first offers enablement sessions during onboarding so the customer is aware that they are available and the list of typical sessions that can be done. Additionally, the CSM should offer a specific session when working with a customer on a use case enablement. The customer collaboration project now has a default issue that has the list of current offerings with a brief description.

Sessions should be captured in Gainsight, which drives the Engagement scorecard metric. Record the date and type of session it was as well as an approximate number of attendees.

Type of sessions

There are two main types of sessions that can be offered. Workshops are generally 1.5-2 hours and include the presentation, demo, and Q&A. These require more preparation and planning and are usually organized by the CSM in collaboration with other CSMs and SAs.

Enablement sessions are generally 1 hour and involve presentation, demo, and Q&A and are usually given by the CSM themselves.

Currently available sessions

The following are already developed, have been given to multiple customers and are available:

- Intro to GitLab (for teams just starting with GitLab) - General intro session that gives a high-level overview of GitLab
- Developer Journey - Idea to Production (for developers, operations, security) - Covers a typical workflow for a developer from getting assigned an issue to work on through creating the merge request, making changes and reviewing the pipeline results, and participating in code reviews
- WebIDE and Markdown (for anyone looking to make changes to code or Pages) - Covers what you

can do with the built-in GitLab WebIDE to make changes to code, files, Pages directly from the GitLab web UI, as well as tips & tricks you can do with GitLab markdown in issues, merge requests, epics, Pages, etc.

- Git Basics (for those who want to contribute on their local machine) - Focuses on the command line interface into GitLab that a developer may need to pull/push code to/from the GitLab server
- CI/CD Basics (for those who want to learn about automated build/test/deploy pipelines) - Covers the basics of how to set up a pipeline to build, test, and deploy your code
- Advanced CI/CD (for those interested in learning more about CI/CD) - Requires basic CI/CD knowledge and covers advanced topics such as includes/extends, rules, child pipelines, and more (specific content will be curated)
- GitLab Security and Compliance (for security, developers, managers, and PMs) - Covers an overview of the security features including how developers see the scan results in the merge request and how security teams can review the results in the Security Dashboard
- DevSecOps Adoption Path (for security & developers) - A prescriptive and curated route to adopting GitLab Secure scanners to get the most ROI as quickly as possible with Secure. This is a great workshop for customers who are struggling with Secure adoption or are just beginning their journey on Ultimate and using GitLab Secure.
- GitLab as a PM tool (for PMs, scrum masters, team leads, developers) - Focuses on organization and use of epics, sub-epics, roadmaps, issues, labels, milestones, and boards
- Issue, labels, and boards (for those interested in learning more about GitLab PM) - Covers more tips & tricks on issues, labels, and boards and is good follow-on after the PM session
- DevOps Metrics with GitLab (for managers, PMs, team leads) - Goes over what the DORA4 metrics are, why it is useful to track them, and what is available in GitLab
- Innersourcing with GitLab (for teams interested in starting code-sharing initiatives internally) - Goes over what is innersourcing, why it is useful, and what are the key things needed for success, followed by how to get started in GitLab
- GitOps with GitLab (for teams looking to use GitLab for Infrastructure as Code) - Goes over what is GitOps, how it is more than just Infrastructure as Code, what are the benefits, and how to get started with GitLab
- GitLab Administration (for GitLab Admins of self-managed instances) - Goes over GitLab components and architecture, installs, upgrades, admin area of the UI, common CLI commands, and back-ups
- Permissions & Access with GitLab (for GitLab Admins of self-managed instances) - Goes over permission access at the Group, Subgroup, Project, and Member levels, and discusses how to effectively tie access in with supported authentication protocols for on and offboarding
- Administration on GitLab SaaS (for GitLab Admins on GitLab.com) - Goes over permissions, access, visibility, licensing, SaaS vs. Self Hosted, audit events and streaming, support, user activity, the future of GitLab Workspace, and all things that help admin roles using SaaS do their jobs

If you have additional sessions you want to contribute, please follow these instructions:

- Save the template deck to the Lunch and Learns Google Drive folder (eventually these will move to Highspot as our single source of truth)
- Update this handbook page to include the name of the session, intended audience, and a summary of the content/goals
- Update the collaboration project template issue to include the same

If you are interested in a session that doesn't exist yet, but you're not able or comfortable

creating it, please post a message in tim-tams about what you would like to see!

Offering the session

CSMs should offer sessions early during onboarding, and whenever working on a stage enablement. If the customer wants a session on a topic we do not already have slides for, request more time to prepare, and then work with the Customer Success team to help pull together some slides for the session. Then the newly created session can be added to the list of existing sessions available to other CSMs.

It is recommended to invite another GitLab team member to the session to help with notes, audience management (including obtaining screenshots of audience participants), and Q&A. This helper could be the Solutions Architect or Account Executive for the account, or it could be a fellow CSM.

Consider the typical length of the session when scheduling. It is recommended to coordinate with your champion on the following information:

- Who is hosting the session
- Will it be recorded
- Who is kicking it off

It is highly recommended to have someone from your regular cadence calls on the session, as some questions asked during the session may be specific to their instance configuration and they will need to answer those questions.

Preparation for the session

The CSM should review the available content for Workshops and Lunch-and-Learns for the topic requested. CSMs can use the content as-is if they feel it will meet their needs or they can make a copy of the slides and customize it for their customer's needs.

CSMs should review the speaker notes to ensure they understand each slide, and add clarifications and notes to them as needed. Ensure you have a plan for what you want to communicate for each slide, but don't try to memorize what you are going to say.

Recordings of sessions that CSMs have previously run can be found [here](#) and may also be helpful to review as part of the preparation process.

Conducting the session

Have your champion introduce you if possible. Use Presenter View in Google Slides to have the speaker notes available in a separate window. Run your slides off of your smaller monitor or on your MacBook screen if possible so the screen resolution is not an issue for participants with lower resolutions.

Introduce yourself and make sure you set ground rules if your champion did not.

For smaller groups (40), you can offer to allow them to come off mute to ask their questions.

For larger groups, it is recommended they put their questions in chat so you can address them at the appropriate time. It is recommended to pause periodically to take questions and also to ensure you stay hydrated during the session.

If you get lost or forget what to say, refer to your speaker notes. It is OK to read directly from them until you get back on track. Feel free to reference other sessions that may cover a topic in more detail, even if you don't have that session planned, as this can generate demand for those sessions and lead to further user adoption and stage enablements. Also, if your customer is on Premium, don't shy away from mentioning Ultimate features during your presentation.

When you do pause for questions, try to answer them but it is OK to say you don't know and will research it and get the answer back to your champion. It is also OK if the question is answered in more detail in another session to simply refer to that session instead of taking too much time during the current one. It is not advised to give out your direct contact information to the audience and instead have them direct future questions to your champion.

After the session

Send a copy of the slides used, and a link to the recording to your champion so they can share it with the participants and with those that could not attend the live session. Follow up on any question that could not be answered. Add a follow-up item to your next cadence call agenda to see what they thought went well and what could be improved for future sessions. Work to schedule other sessions based on demand. IF there are participants you are not familiar with who attended the webinar, please follow up with your day to day contact to better understand if/how additional teams are using GitLab and what/if any trainings are needed.

Session Notes

Similar to taking notes in a cadence call, it is useful to add to your running notes doc in each enablement session you run for the customer. Include a list of attendees, max participant count, record of questions and answers provided, and any follow-up items that were not addressed during the session

Best Practices for Note-Taking & Planning

- Write down your agenda (including questions you want to ask). This way you can quickly add your notes for the specific context.
- If you're comfortable writing in Markdown format, use it to quickly structure your notes in real time.
- Allow yourself time directly after the call to clean up your notes. Avoid scheduling back-to-back meetings.
- Practice slowing down call conversations. Stopping the dialog for a few seconds to say "let me write that down" tells the customer what they said is important to you.
- Ask your SAE/AE/SA to take notes with you. After the meeting combine and add detail.
- Use Gong to record your calls so there's less pressure for you to take note of everything.
- Sometimes it makes sense for somebody on the account team to go back through the call in Chorus to transcribe it.
- Write notes in whatever is easiest and always copy them to your best source of truth. If you can write them in the source of truth in the first place, you'll be more efficient and

consistent

- Leverage the Workshop Planning Checklist for planning calls with the customer

SECTION: customer-success/csm/adoption-landing-zones/_index.md

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Adoption Enablement

Highspot Pages

SECTION: customer-success/csm/adoption-landing-zones/ci.md

Journey Stage	Solutions
No agreement	Next Generation DevOps Deck (w/ talk track) Trap setting questions How to convince leadership to adopt CI/CD EBook
Kickoff/Planning	CI Rollout Strategy Planning a migration documentation
Migration	PS Offerings

Jenkins to GitLab: The ultimate guide to modernizing your CI/CD environment PS Offerings - Migration guidance from 4 different CI tools (Bamboo, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, CircleCI)	- Jenkins to GitLab CSM Enablement - CSM led enablement sessions - Hands-On Technical Workshops - Scale Webinars
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Discovery Questions

1. Robust list of initial discovery questions to help better understand the customer use case: [Public Handbook Page](#)

Quickstart Guides

1. Supplemental Resource: CI/CD Quickstart - Premium: [Public-Facing Page](#)
 - To create personalized Highspot Pitches using Styles and Templates, refer to the following components:
 - Premium version:
 - Pitch Template
 - Pitch Style
 - Ultimate version:
 - Pitch Template
 - Pitch Style
2. DevOps Solution Resource: Continuous Integration: [Public Handbook Page](#)
3. CI Workshop Planning Overview: [Public Handbook Page](#)

Migrating to GitLab

GitHub to GitLab

1. Blog: [Github to GitLab Migration Made Easy](#)
1. GitHub Actions to GitLab: Video [Highspot link](#)

Jenkins to GitLab

1. Docs page: 'How To' Overview: Docs Page: Migrating from Jenkins
1. Jenkins Integration demo (CS-Led): CSM Demo: Jenkins Integration
1. Jenkins Discovery Questions: Technical Customer Deep Dive

Adoption Enablement

1. Intro to CI/CD (CSM-Led):
 - Customer-facing: Public-Facing Deck
 - Internal: Internal Highspot Link
1. Advanced CI/CD (CSM-Led):
 - Customer-facing: Public-Facing Deck
 - Internal: Internal Highspot Link
1. Standardizing CI/CD (CSM-Led):
 - Customer-facing: Public-Facing Deck
 - Internal: Internal Highspot Link
1. Runner Overview: Link to Deck
1. Webinars (Informational & Hands-On):
 - Monthly Webinar Calendar

Product Features or Enhancements Coming Soon That Will Accelerate CI setup and adoption

1. CI Component Catalog: <https://docs.gitlab.com/ee/ci/components/>
 - Quick demo on how the CI Component Catalog Works VIDEO
 - Epic outlining the business need and customer pain point this catalog will solve: <https://gitlab.com/groups/gitlab-org/-/epics/7462>
 - Epic housing future feature enhancements: <https://gitlab.com/groups/gitlab-org/-/epics/9897>

SECTION: customer-success/csm/adoption-landing-zones/devsecops.md

SECTION: customer-success/csm/calendly/index.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

For an overview of Chorus, the tool used to record our meetings please refer to the Gainsight Overview Page.

Setup Calendly for Customer Success Managers/Engineers

CSMs and CSEs use Calendly to efficiently manage customer requests for booking ad-hoc meetings.

Chorus Initial Setup for Static Link

To ensure that Calendly is setup to comply with GDPR and similar privacy laws, all team members with a Recorder license in Chorus are required to use a feature called Chorus Scheduler when organizing meetings with customers. Below are the steps required to use Chorus Scheduler for your events booked via Calendly.

- Visit Learn How to Use Chorus.ai for instructions on how to create a Static Link from Chorus Scheduler.
- To create/view the Static Link
 - Link your Zoom PMI in the Chorus Scheduler Settings (one time only)
 - Then create a test event on your Google calendar, click Add video conferencing, select Chorus Meeting. You will then be able to view the Chorus Go static link (Domain: go.chorus.ai).
-

Creating a Calendly Event Type

It is recommended to create multiple event types for your Calendly to ensure customers can choose the appropriate length of time for the meeting or specific topic/area of focus. Below is an example home page on Calendly for a CSE with different event types.

Instructions for Creating Calendly Event

- Login to calendly and view all of your event types here:
<https://calendly.com/eventtypes/user/me>
- Click the Create New Event Type Button and choose One-on-One
- Event name: Name your event based on the length of time or specific topic/focus (Ex: New Customer: Onboarding Call)
- Location: Custom (Use a Static Link from Chorus Scheduler generated from your Zoom PMI)
 - Next, add the go.chorus.ai link to your calendly event configuration Location field.
 - Important Note: Anyone booking through your calendly would use the same location link when booking an event instead of an automatically generated unique meeting ID per meeting. Please make sure your Zoom Personal Meeting follows GitLab's best practices on privacy and security.
- Make sure to select display location only after confirmation
-
- Description/Instructions (add the following recommended text)
 - > This face-to-face meeting may be recorded. A browser will be required to access this meeting invite. If you do not have access to a browser, please contact the meeting organizer.
 - >
 - > You will join a Zoom meeting via Chorus.ai

>
>
>

> Recording Disclaimer: This meeting will be recording with Chorus.ai. By accepting this meeting invite or joining the meeting room, you consent to the recording.

- When can people book this event?

- Date range: 60

- Best practice: Always make sure your calendar is up to date with PTO, Holidays, busy blocks to ensure your personal time/focus time is protected.

- Duration: Your desired meeting time length for the event type

- Best practice notes: Prefer speedy meetings, so use 15, 25, 50 minutes as meeting lengths for example.

- How do you want to offer your availability for this event type?

- Use an existing schedule

- Which schedule do you want to use for this event type?

- Working hours

- Want to add time before or after your events?

- Before event: 15 min

- (unfurl the Additional rules for your availability section/link)

- Start time increments: 30 minutes (allows more options for a customer to book)

- Scheduling conditions

- Invitees can't schedule within: 2 days of an event start time

- Best practice notes: If you are new/just coming out of onboarding, 2 days gives you enough time to research the customer, review support tickets, GitLab issues and sync with the account team if needed. Also allows for buffer time if a customer happens to want to book time on the weekend so you don't have a call first thing on Monday morning for example.

- Modification notes: Once you are comfortable in the role and gained enough experience, you should consider shortening the condition from 2 days to 1 day to encourage more bookings with customers.

- Maximum allowed events per day for this type of event: 2

- Best practice notes: Allows you to have the time and space to review your notes/recording and start research for a follow-up response, as well as handle other duties as a CSM/CSE (providing assistance to webinar Q&A, professional development, internal meetings, focus time, etc.)

- Time zone display: automatically detect

- Secret event: unchecked/disabled

SECTION: customer-success/csm/csm-manager/_index.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

Purpose

This page provides an overview on relevant CSM leadership processes.

CS Leadership

Name	Region	Level	Team
Sherrod Patching	Global	VP	CS
Ally Frusciano	Global	Director	CSE
Erica Sivak	AMER	Senior Manager	CSE
Oliver Falk	EMEA	Manager	CSE
Catherine Ballantyne	APJ	Director	CSM/E
Kent Georgeson	Global	Director	Success Services
Sophie Pouliquen	AMER East	Senior Manager	CSM
Chloe Whitestone	AMER East	Manager	CSM
Tiffany McAtee	AMER East	Senior Manager	CSM
Jamie Reid	AMER West	Manager	CSM
Cedric Stapleton	AMER West	Manager	CSM
Michael Leutz	EMEA	Director	CSM
Christina Souleles	DACH	Senior Manager	CSM
Robert Clark	PubSec	Manager	CSM & CSE
Steven Terhar	PubSec	Manager	CSM & CSE

CSM Manager Responsibilities & Requirements

Responsibility	Context	How We Measure
Account Reviews in 1:1s (weekly)	- Review CSM responsibilities, provide coaching and guidance on overcoming objections and challenges where needed - The structure of 1:1s generally follows the documented 1:1 cadence. The manager updates their manager one week later, ensuring that successes and challenges are shared in a programmatic way across the leadership team - It is recommended that 1:1s are 45-60 minutes to adequately cover all agenda items	CSM/Manager shows a knowledgeable understanding of their book of business, and competency in CSM motion
Reviews & Coaching	- It is important that the CSM manager is actively coaching their CSMs on the above requirements - Managers are encouraged to set time aside to review upcoming Customer call agendas, success plans, workshops and account health for coaching opportunities - see below for more detail on these reviews	Managers follow the

onboarding-review">review guidelines documented, review outside of the 1:1 </td></tr>		
<td><td>Call Reviews</td></td>	<td>Call Reviews</td>	
<td> For coaching, a CSM manager is to review CSM callsIt is encouraged that the CSM suggests the call for review, highlighting a call that went very well, or one in which there was a challenge, and talking through coaching would be of value to the CSM</td> </td>	For coaching, a CSM manager is to review CSM callsIt is encouraged that the CSM suggests the call for review, highlighting a call that went very well, or one in which there was a challenge, and talking through coaching would be of value to the CSM</td>	
<td>1-2 calls per week (total) from Chorus for their team.</td></tr></td>	1-2 calls per week (total) from Chorus for their team.</td></tr>	
<td>Team development (quarterly)</td></td>	Team development (quarterly)</td>	
<td> The manager schedules an additional 1-hour sync to discuss their IDP and progress/obstaclesThe CSM is responsible for building and maintaining this document in partnership with their managerWhen a CSM is working towards a promotion, the promotion doc is built and collaborated on in partnership between the CSM and CSM manager. It is the manager's role to ensure the areas the CSM needs to develop to move towards the promotion are clear and articulated</td> </td>	The manager schedules an additional 1-hour sync to discuss their IDP and progress/obstaclesThe CSM is responsible for building and maintaining this document in partnership with their managerWhen a CSM is working towards a promotion, the promotion doc is built and collaborated on in partnership between the CSM and CSM manager. It is the manager's role to ensure the areas the CSM needs to develop to move towards the promotion are clear and articulated</td>	
<td>An active IDP in place for every team member, reviewed on a quarterly basis</td></tr></td>	An active IDP in place for every team member, reviewed on a quarterly basis</td></tr>	
<td> <td> Escalations</td></td> </td>	<td> Escalations</td></td>	Escalations </td>
<td> It is the role of the manager to understand the escalation process, coach their CSM through it, and step in to assist in managing when the CSM is not getting the progress needed.</td></td>	It is the role of the manager to understand the escalation process , coach their CSM through it, and step in to assist in managing when the CSM is not getting the progress needed.</td>	
<td>Active manager participation in an escalation, including ensuring the update cadence is met and the teams are aligned</td></tr></td>	Active manager participation in an escalation, including ensuring the update cadence is met and the teams are aligned</td></tr>	

Review Processes

Below are some of the top processes to be performed by CSM Managers on a recurring cadence. The overall goal is to ensure the CSM Manager has a strong grasp on their team's group of customers through various data points (health, Support tickets, Onboarding objects, renewals, etc.). Resources such as Dashboards and videos are included for easy reference.

Review Checklist

For CSM Managers, here is a short checklist to assist in the review:

- Account assignment: Accounts have been reviewed and are assigned or are in review
- Customer Onboarding: Customers in the Onboarding phase have been reviewed and onboarding status and notes are complete
- Success Plans: Customers have a Success Plan, it is being communicated with the customer, and the CSM is using it as the guiding document
- At-Risk Customers: Health for all CSM-assigned accounts have been updated within the last month, and any accounts at-risk (Red, Yellow trending down) are being evaluated
- Renewal Review: Upcoming customer renewals have been reviewed · the CSM has updated customer

health and communicated with the SAE and SA for the upcoming renewal

Account Assignment

Accounts are assigned at point of sale by the CSM Manager when a new Account in their region fits the criteria in CSM Responsibilities and Services.

When an Account meets the criteria, the following will happen:

- The CSM Manager assigns the CSM by populating the CSM Name field on the C360 account page in Gainsight (only managers have the ability to edit this field)
- Once the field has been updated with the CSM name, Gainsight will fire the onboarding playbook
- If the account meets the above criteria and the CSM is not assigned, Gainsight will fire a CTA (call to action) for the CSM manager asking them to assign the account. Gainsight will then 'listen' for the CSM field to be populated and will fire the onboarding playbook once the field has been updated with the CSM name

While the SAE owns the transition-to-CSM aspect, the CSM Manager will then ensure the new account is assigned to a CSM and Onboarding has commenced.

Assignment Resources

- Onboarding Handbook
- Gainsight Dashboard - CS Leadership

Customer Onboarding Review

On a regular basis, the CSM Manager should review their team's active Onboarding plays. The Onboarding plays can be reviewed with each individual in one-on-one meetings. Onboarding is measured by the time to value metrics. Consider:

1. How many and which accounts are in onboarding?
2. What do Time to Value metrics look like?
3. After looking at the detail, what are areas we want to improve and areas to celebrate?

Onboarding Resources

- Account Onboarding Handbook
- Gainsight Dashboard - CSM Portfolio or Customer Onboarding

KPI Tracking in Gainsight

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<figure class="videocontainer">

<iframe src="https://www.youtube.com/embed/Vm32wtRqkK8" title="Onboarding Metrics - Why and Where/How They Are Tracked - Gainsight" frameborder="0" allowfullscreen="true"> </iframe>

</figure>

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- Time to engagement is calculated by the addition of a timeline entry or type Cadence Call or Meeting.
- Time to first value uses license utilisation as a proxy for users actively using the platform with a threshold of 10%
 - Automatically calculated when Cloud Licensing turned on (Note: If Cloud Licensing is not enabled from the outset, this automation can cause invalid outliers, in this scenario manually correct)
 - Manually collected by the CSM in collaboration with the customer when License data isn't available
- Time to onboard is calculated by onboarding enablement complete not infrastructure ready

Success Plan Review

On a regular basis the CSM Manager should review their team's Success Plans. At a minimum, the review should include:

1. What is the customer's documented strategy and is that aligned to why they bought?
 1. Are all parties (SAE/AE, SA, CSM, customer) aligned on the stated goals?
 1. If the objectives are met, are they in the customer's best interest?
 1. Are the outcomes measurable (either as a deliverable or quantifiable)?
 1. Is the customer on track to meet or exceed their business outcomes?
 1. Are the next steps for demonstrating value defined and in place?

The CSM Manager should then work with their team to help the CSM drive up and demonstrate value to the customer.

Success Plan Resources

- Success Plan Handbook
- Gainsight Dashboard - CSM Portfolio or CS Leadership

Health Review and At-Risk Customers

On at least a monthly basis, review accounts within your region in preparation for a biweekly At-Risk call. This includes reviewing:

1. Gainsight dashboards for unhealthy accounts
 1. SFDC Reports on red accounts
 1. Gainsight at-risk comments per account

Details for all at-risk account should be captured in Gainsight using an At-Risk Update timeline entry. These updates are synced to Salesforce, and reports used to review at-risk accounts draw on these updates.

At-Risk Review Meetings

At-risk customer meetings are conducted on a regular basis across regions and at a global level. The table below provides an overview of the different meetings conducted.

| Region/Territory | Cadence | Roles |

|---|---|---|

Global CSM	Weekly; alternating biweekly for EMEA and APAC friendly times	VP of Customer Success, VP of CSMs, CSM Regional Directors and/or Managers, Director of Renewals
AMER ENT West	Biweekly	CSM: Director, Managers; Sales: AVP, ASMs; Renewals: RM Manager
AMER ENT East	Biweekly	CSM: Director, Managers; Sales: AVP, ASMs; Renewals: RM Manager
AMER COM	Weekly	CSM: Director, Managers; Sales: AVP, ASMs
EMEA COM	Weekly	CSM: Director, Managers; Sales: AVP, ASMs
APAC	Bi-Weekly	CSM: Manager; Sales: AVP, ENT & COM ASMs
Public Sector	Biweekly	VP of Customer Success, VP of Public Sector, Director of Customer Success, ASMs, CSM and Renewals Team Managers

Purpose and output of at-risk review meetings

Regional at-risk review meetings are to ensure cross-functional alignment on at-risk accounts. The purpose of the meeting is:

- Align on the cause(s) of risk
- Determine what needs to be accomplished to resolve risk
- Agree on next steps & ownership of those actions

CSM Managers align with their team members about any agreed-upon action items or updates for customers, and those details are captured in an At-Risk Update by the CSM, who will manage and coordinate the defined next steps.

Regional Review Agenda

The regional at-risk meetings use a specified format, to ensure consistent action & alignment on at-risk customers globally:

- > For each cohort listed below, we will discuss the following details:
 - >
 - > - What is the primary driver of risk?
 - > - What do we need to accomplish to mitigate the risk?
 - > - Next steps & ownership
 - >
- > Customer Cohorts
 - >
 - > 1. At-risk renewals in current FQ
 - > 1. At-risk renewals in next FQ
 - > 1. All At-risk customers above \$100k ARR (any FQ)
 - > 1. Any other customers that warrant discussion outside of those groups
 - >
- > Reports for review
 - >
 - > 1. FQ At-Risk Accounts \$100k ARR and Above [Update linked report to one for your region]

Update the date range for Close Date at the top of the report to view the relevant fiscal quarter. Doing it this way allows us to work from a single report across all relevant customer cohorts. The priority in this meeting is current FQ and next FQ, but as time permits other at-risk customers should be reviewed.

The CSM Manager(s) within the region should drive the meeting, in collaboration with the Renewal Manager leadership and ASMs as appropriate for each customer. Discussion and action should be driven by the Salesforce report for the region, working from At-Risk Update details and Renewal Manager notes.

Renewal Review

At least twice-monthly the CSM Manager should review their region's dashboard for upcoming renewals and review questions such as:

1. Which renewals are coming this quarter?
1. Which renewals are coming in the next 2-3 quarters?
1. What is the health of the accounts?
1. Is the health of each account up to date?
1. Based on this analysis, what are my next steps for the customer's success and our Gross and Net Retention goals?

The CSM Manager should then work with their CSM to ensure collaboration with the GitLab team (SAE/AE, SA, and CSM) for a successful renewal.

This review also leads into the regional review meeting to ensure the right information and plans are documented.

Commission Exception Review Process

Current Exception Process

1. Chatter - CSM Managers chatter VP of CSMS and Sales-comp for Pooled CSM Team updates and when approved it is processed by the sales team and there is a reply to the manager
2. Deal Exceptions Spreadsheet - FY23 Deal Exceptions/Accounts Requiring Review CSM (INTERNAL ONLY) managers would explain deal exceptions mainly for renewal rate exceptions on this spreadsheet and get approval and then it is processed by the comp team

Future Exception Process

Moving to one exception process through SFDC chatter. Sales-comp is tagged on chatter for the required exception with the required approval. If it is a CSM pooled field change request then the comp team will process it and reply back on chatter. If it is a Renewal Rate/Growth ARR opportunity exception then the applicable exception checkbox is checked on the opportunity by the comp team and replied to the team by tagging the requestor. System team can help create a chatter report for the teams to view and this helps to collate all requests in one place.

Renewal Resources

- Renewal Review Handbook
- CSM Regional Dashboard
- Gainsight Dashboard

Quarterly Business Review (QBR)

The CSM Manager is responsible for developing and delivering a Quarterly Business Review for their team each quarter.

CSM Manager QBR details

Gainsight/Customer Review in Director/CSM Manager 1:1 Cadence

This is a suggested cadence that can be used by regional CSM managers in their weekly 1:1s with the CSM VP, and additionally used for other CSM Manager 1:1 meetings

1st week is defined as the first full week of the month.

1st week:

- 1. KPIs: nARR, renewal rate (async)
- 1. Team: Hiring, Career Dev, Risk
- 1. Customers: Escalations & Risk. SFDC Report: At-Risk Customers

2nd week:

- 1. KPIs: nARR, renewal rate (async)
- 1. Top 50 customer review. Tableau Report, OR Gainsight Dashboard - Customer Health sort by ARR
- 1. OKR / Big Rock initiatives progress

3rd week:

- 1. KPIs: nARR, renewal rate (async)
- 1. Team: Hiring, Career Dev, Risk
- 1. Customers: Escalations & Risk. SFDC Report - At-Risk Customers

4th week:

- 1. KPIs: nARR, renewal rate (async)
- 1. Ultimate Customers. Sisense dashboard OR Gainsight Dashboard - Use Case Adoption
 - 1. Purchased last Qtr
 - 1. By ARR
- 1. OKR / Big Rock initiatives progress

Annual Processes

President's Club Calculations

President's Club criteria and processes are documented in the GitLab internal handbook.

Team Member Performance

Managers have the responsibility of evaluating and providing feedback on team member performance. We have resources available to help with this:

- Individual FY Plan: One-sheet outline of the key metrics & criteria for a team member to

achieve in a given fiscal year, tailored to the team member. This is best used at the beginning of the fiscal year, assembled by the manager and discussed with the team member. Categories and metrics should be agreed upon by manager and team member, and performance against these reviewed regularly throughout the year.

Promotion planning

The CSM Manager should provide regular coaching and guidance on where a CSM stands and how to fill any gaps before they are eligible to be promoted. When a CSM is ready for promotion, the CSM Manager should collaborate with the CSM on the promotion document. When building the doc, it is important to lead with the results the CSM has achieved, supported with links to content, issues, MRs, etc.

SECTION: customer-success/csm/csm-manager/qbr.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

The CSM Manager is responsible for developing and delivering a Quarterly Business Review for their team each quarter.

The Quarterly Business Review is a tool to evaluate, report on, learn from the actions and performance of the team over the quarter, and share asks and priorities for the next quarter. CSM QBRs follow the same schedule as Sales QBRs, and should be presented during Sales QBR sessions for the CSM Manager's region.

Preparing a CSM QBR

Each quarter, a CSM QBR presentation template is developed to assist managers in developing their QBR with emphasis on the details that Customer Success and the CSM organization is focused on. Use this template as a starting point, and add additional details that are relevant to your team's story.

Presenting a CSM QBR

The schedule of CSM QBR presentations may vary each quarter, but typically QBRs are presented by each manager to the rest of the CSM leadership in a dedicated session, and then each CSM Manager presents their QBR during their region's Sales QBR sessions.

When presenting your QBR during Sales QBR sessions, you may have a very limited amount of time for your presentation. Have a plan to present your QBR with a focus on the highlights, and consider assembling an abbreviated version of your presentation.

SECTION: customer-success/csm/csm-manager/risk-renewal.md

Managing risk & renewals is a core responsibility of CSMs, and managers at all levels are involved in this process.

This page outlines the different actions and processes CSM management have for account risk & renewals.

Renewal management & forecasting

CSM Managers work with their team members, and with colleagues in other groups (e.g. Sales, Renewals Management), to manage and plan for upcoming renewals.

Alignment between CSM Manager & Manager of Renewals

On a weekly basis, the CSM Manager and Manager of Renewals discuss and update details for upcoming renewals.

Regional field leaders risk & renewal review

Regional field leaders (CSM Managers, ASMs, AVPs, etc.) from Sales and CS meet regularly to review at-risk accounts and upcoming renewals in their territory.

PLACEHOLDER: ADD DETAILS FOR ALIGNMENT HERE

At-risk account reviews

The CRO organization conducts recurring reviews of at-risk accounts at several levels. These reviews roll up from one level to the next.

CSM global review

Cadence: Weekly, alternating EMEA and APAC friendly times each week

Direct reports to the VP of Customer Success Management provide updates and discuss action for at-risk customers with upcoming renewals. Focus is on the following:

1. Largest all-time customers by ARR
1. Top at-risk customers by ARR for current & next quarter

CRO global risk review

Cadence:

Global field leaders provide an update on at-risk accounts to the CRO leadership team.

SECTION: customer-success/csm/csm-manager/roles/_index.md

SECTION: customer-success/csm/csm-manager/roles/operations-manager.md

Overview

The Operations Manager is a regional role, held by a Senior CSM Manager. The Operations Manager works with the CSM Regional Director to ensure operational plans are clearly defined, and consistency across the teams in the region is established & maintained. The Operations Manager works with the CSM Managers in the region to implement operational plans, provide guidance, and verify consistency of operations across the teams.

This role is in addition to the Senior CSM Manager's responsibilities managing their team.

Responsibilities

- Establish and maintain operational plans to manage success plan validation, EBRs, at-risk accounts, renewals, and CSM motions applicable for CSMs across their books of business.
- Work cross-functionally with leaders in other parts of the organization (e.g. Field team leaders, Product, Support) to identify gaps or inefficiencies in our processes, and make improvements biased for efficiency, simplicity, and results.
- Oversee and guide on Big Rocks & OKRs led by team members or managers in the region, and keep track of progress against deliverables for those initiatives across the teams in the region.
- Manage and coordinate short-term customer action efforts related to product requirements (e.g. feedback and asks from across our customer base on ML/AI)

SECTION: customer-success/csm/csm-onboarding/_index.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

Onboarding for Customer Success Managers is a guided, methodical process to ensure new team members have the knowledge they need to be effective.

There is a lot to learn to make you a great GitLab Customer Success Manager. It is important for new team members to gain competency on how our platform solutions provide customer value, and how we partner with customers to build a productive relationship. This handbook page will provide an overview of what can be expected during the onboarding journey including learning objectives, milestones, and ways in which a manager and onboarding buddy can support a new team member during their onboarding.

Overview of Role Based Customer Success Manager (CSM) Onboarding

As a CSM, your onboarding experience will be a blended learning experience that includes virtual synchronous meetings, a self-paced role-based learning path on LevelUp (our internal Learning Management System), and a hands-on virtual workshop called Sales Quick Start (SQS).

The role-based learning path is highlighted in this role-specific onboarding guide. It is recommended that you make a copy of this document and check off items as you complete them.

Learning Objectives for CSM Onboarding

As a CSM, in addition to the SQS learning objectives, your onboarding is intended to fulfill the following learning objectives:

Module 1: CSM Basics and Call Shadowing

- Complete Pulse+ Customer Success Manager Certificate I
- Complete Pulse+ Advanced Customer Success Manager Certificate II
- Understand the different stages of call shadowing

Module 1.5: Demo Environment

- Demonstrate understanding of GitLab Basics
- Understand the stages of the DevSecOps Lifecycle
- Understand the different pricing tiers of GitLab
- Complete Demo Systems Initial Set Up

Module 2: CSM at GitLab

- Understand the role of a CSM at GitLab
- Understand the mission and vision of the Customer Success organization
- Understand the CSM-s responsibilities within the customer journey
- Understand the distinction between CSMs and Customer Success Engineers (CSEs)
- Understand the rhythm of business for a CSM
- Demonstrate customer readiness by completing role play exercise

Module 3: Technical Deep Dive

- Complete the following certification: GitLab Certified Git Associate
- Understand the CSM-s responsibilities as it relates to customer cadence calls

Module 4: CSM Deep Dive

- Understand Value Based Conversations
- Understand your role and responsibilities as a CSM as it relates to Success Plans
- Understand how to navigate and what resources to find on Highspot
- Understand the direction, value, and methodology of Professional Services at GitLab

Module 5: Tools and Best Practices

- Complete the following certification: GitLab Certified CI/CD Associate
- Understand the workflow and documentation practices for Gainsight and Salesforce
- Understand reference architectures and their associated costs

Module 6: EBR and Customer Conversations

- Understand the CSM's role and responsibilities as it relates to Executive Business Reviews (EBRs) with your customer
- Complete the following certification: GitLab Certified Security Specialist
- Understand value based discovery for DevSecOps

Module 7: CSM Onboarding Conclusion

- Complete the following certification: GitLab Certified Project Management

Milestones and Onboarding Roadmap

Expectations for Manager support during onboarding

As a new CSM, your manager will be there to support you during your onboarding journey. Beyond the expectations laid out for your manager in your onboarding issue, you can anticipate they will also provide you support on the following:

Month 1

- Schedule recurring 1:1s and check in calls
- Provide guidance on who the new team member should schedule coffee chats with during their onboarding journey
- Review and discuss company policies
 - PTO policy
 - Family and Friends first culture
 - CREDIT Values
- Discuss any team specific expectations
- Review organizational structure
- Ensure new team member has access to role-specific tools and appropriate Slack channels
- Align on a general plan to get customer ready including who to schedule your onboarding role plays with and shadow at least 4 calls per week
- Ensure new team member is meeting expected milestones from week to week
- Identify skills to be mastered and resources available to accomplish learning objectives

Month 2

- Check in regularly with your new team member
 - Ask them if they are experiencing any challenges with GitLab's asynchronous culture
 - Discuss any general concerns
- Share constructive feedback on role plays that were completed during the onboarding learning path
- Ensure onboarding milestones are met and that new team member is completing required courses and certifications
- Align on whether your new team member is on track to be customer ready and how else you can provide support to get them ramped
- Discuss best practices and rules of engagement for CSMs

Month 3

- Decide on a regular cadence for 1:1 calls
- Prep your new team member for taking over assigned customers/accounts
- Consider shadowing your new team member's customer calls and provide feedback as needed
- Confirm that new team member has completed all mandatory and necessary onboarding activities including SQS and role-based learning path
- Discuss how their performance will be formally evaluated

Beyond 3 months

- Provide regular feedback on performance
- Partner with employee to develop an individual growth plan for goals they want to achieve in the coming year
- Discuss the following topics at length in the coming months by providing an overview of the topic, why is it important to customer / GitLab / CSM, what does good look like, what are some common pitfalls, and how success is measured:
 - Cadence Calls
 - Success Plans
 - EBRs
 - Customer Escalations
 - Customer Enablement
 - Gainsight Hygiene

Expectations for Buddy support during onboarding

Month 1

- Nurture a welcoming environment for the new team member
- Establish a recurring 1:1 meeting to check in on the new team member's progress on onboarding activities
- Provide assistance with any barriers or difficulty understanding concepts covered in the onboarding learning path and SQS
- Connect the new team member with members of the broad team to build a network
- Share helpful tips and resources that are beneficial during their onboarding and beyond

Month 2

- Provide opportunities for new team member to shadow you on calls as defined in the shadow criteria and assist with note taking
- Debrief on calls and discuss feedback
- Align with new team member's manager on ways you can provide support

Month 3

- Co-lead calls with the new team member until they are ready to take over customer interactions independently
- Share constructive feedback
- Inform new team member on how you can support them beyond their onboarding journey

The buddy should join the first 5-10 customer meetings led by the new joiner.

- It is not only for technical guidance but much more for general feedback and building confidence in the CSM role.
- The close feedback loop will enable new CSMs to learn faster by helping them understand if their approach was the best one, where they can improve, and what went well.
- Generally, increased interaction between the onboarding buddy and new CSM will reduce the onboarding time.
- Asking questions and feeling comfortable doing so, improved new hire satisfaction to start working with clients

Graduation from CSM Onboarding

In order to be considered as having graduated from your CSM onboarding journey, you need to have completed the following:

- Completed Sales Quick Start (SQS) prework on GitLab University
- Attended the SQS workshop and completed all relevant activities
- Completed your role-based learning path on GitLab University
- Completed the Pulse+ CSM Certificate I and Advanced CSM Certificate II
- Attained the following certificates:
 - GitLab Certified Git Associate
 - GitLab Certified CI/CD Associate
 - GitLab Certified Project Management Associate
 - GitLab Certified Security Specialist
- Completed role play activities and discussed feedback with your manager / onboarding buddy
- Shadowed at least 4 calls per week throughout your onboarding and discussed with your manager

Continuous Enablement

For high level information on enablement initiatives for the Customer Success Manager/Engineer teams, please refer to the CS Enablement Corner. Additionally, please be sure to check out the CS Development Handbook page.

You will be receiving calendar invitations for Customer Success Skills Exchange and Field Enablement Spotlight sessions. Customer Success Skills Exchange is a biweekly series while Field Enablement Spotlight is a weekly session. Both cover various topics related to and pertinent to the field. Please be sure to join and participate in these sessions!

Feedback

Your feedback on the onboarding process is important to us and we welcome your thoughts and ideas about how we can improve in the future. Please share your feedback in the following issue: CSM Onboarding Feedback.

Support and our Single Source of Truth

Since GitLab is a handbook first organization, the answer to any question you may have particularly throughout your first thirty days should be documented and readily available as this is our Single Source of Truth (SSoT).

If you are unable to find the information you are looking for, please be sure to reach out to

your Manager; Onboarding Buddy; People Connect Team member or Enablement Program Manager for support by tagging them in the comments section of this issue. If you need to troubleshoot specific issues with tools, you can add a screenshot of the issue directly in the comment to help them diagnose the problem.

Alternatively once you are active on Slack, which is used solely for informal communication, you will notice that you have been automatically added to a handful of useful support channels such questions, cs-questions, solutions-architects, it-help, etc.

Meeting shadowing

To learn how we conduct both customer meetings and internal planning meetings, a new team member will shadow these meetings with one or more established members of the team.

Meeting Shadowing

Customer Handover

After you have completed both the general and the role-based onboarding and you feel comfortable with working with customers, you will start the onboarding to your first customer account. In case you are taking over your first customer from another CSM, the Account Handoff CSM-to-CSM Checklist is a very helpful resource. This handbook page also contains a list of questions that you can answer and afterwards discuss with the current CSM on the account. That way, the handover process will be smoother and you ensure that no important customer topic is forgotten. When preparing for the account handover, take a look at the Google Drive folder for the customer, Gainsight, Salesforce, Zendesk and the corresponding GitLab collaboration project. In Gainsight, it is particularly helpful to go through the timeline and the success plan for the customer to get a quick overview of ongoing topics, initiatives and issues.

CSM Office Hours

We host weekly CSM office hours meetings to help you answer questions in a judgment-free space. You can add your questions to the agenda document linked in the Google Calendar invite and hop on the call to work through questions or learn how to find helpful resources.

Helpful resources for faster onboarding

By talking to new hires and recent new CSM team members, it was identified that the onboarding buddy relationship plays a critical role for success of a new hire in the CSM team. Existing CSMs explained that having a very close / short loop to their onboarding saw a close relationship as a tremendous speed up of their onboarding.

Buddies should always be CSMs (same department), to match the role as close as possible, as it will help the new hire to resolve questions around their responsibilities and tasks quicker and more efficient, compared to going through multiple chats or calls. To pick an onboarding buddy, CSM managers will use the guidance section for buddies from our general handbook section.

SLACK Channels

New team members often struggle to find the right set of slack channels to participate in, and

to filter out noise that is not relevant to them, especially in the first weeks of their start in the CSM team. The following list should provide an initial set of channels that will be helpful to new hires.

- CSM - General

- cs-questions
- customer-success
- sales-support
- field-fyi
- csm-updates
- tim-tams

- GitLab - General

- questions
- whats-happening-at-gitlab
- company-fyi
- it-help
- aifieldstrategy
- people-connect
- escalatedcustomers
- thanks
- whats-happening-at-gitlab

- CSM - Regional - EMEA / DACH Team

- team-csm-dach
- emea-customer-success
- team-csm-emea
- social-csm-emea

For all product management related questions, a CSM should review our handbook page at following location to identify the right channel for the topic they are looking to learn more. Those team channels should be asked if there is no documentation available for the problem/question and also if the CSM did not find an issue that already discusses this question.

A great resource to learn how to engage with GitLab product is available in the product handbook [here](#)

Handbook Pages and Resources

Collection of key handbook pages and other resources for CSMs to read and focus on when onboarding in their first 3 months

- CSM - New Team Member - Onboarding Guide
- CSM Onboarding Learning Path
- Sales Quick Start (SQS) Handbook Page
- Customer Success Enablement Issue Board

- CSM Onboarding Feedback Issue
- CSM Onboarding at GitLab
- Responsibilities and Services of a CSM at GitLab
- Using Gainsight
- Searching GitLab like a pro
- Answer client questions
- Process for CSM lead account escalations
- STAR - Process for managing support tickets that, due to the situation that is critical for the customer's business, require our attention
- Process for CSM to CSM Account Handoff
- Available development paths and resources for Customer Success Managers at GitLab
- DevOps - Foundations Learning

Product Knowledge

Collection of initial set of key product links, which will help in the first 4-6 weeks of onboarding as a new hire.

- Offerings: GitLab Dedicated vs. GitLab SaaS vs. GitLab Self Managed
 - Self Managed: In GitLab Self-managed you will have full control over the server itself and the environment
 - Dedicated:: A single-tenant SaaS service for highly regulated and large enterprises
 - SaaS: The GitLab software-as-a-service offering. You don't need to install anything to use GitLab SaaS, you only need to sign up and start using GitLab straight away
- GitLab Self Managed
 - GitLab Application components (details)
 - Installation Methods
 - Reference Architectures
 - Runners (GitLab's "worker" for CI/CD jobs - pipelines)
 - Upgrade & Update of GitLab
 - Upgrade Path
- Key functionality of GitLab
 - AI
 - CI / CD
 - SCM
- GitLab Product
 - Pricing
 - Find responsible SLACK Channel and Team for GitLab features
 - Stages - Separat